ji himself intervened and patiently listened to everyone for almost an hour and a half. He even took along those whom he couldn't interact with in the first walking interaction of that afternoon, thereby pushing forward the other scheduled walking interactions. (Note: To streamline the walking interactions, typically ten to twelve civil society interactions were organized per day. Delegations were asked to stop ahead along the Yatra's route and were spaced out every two kilometres, so that each delegation would get quality time with Rahul Gandhi. These delegations were made to walk into the Yatra when it came within sight.)

But I deviate. Simply to ensure most of the work got done effectively, we had internally divided tasks among ourselves. I took on the task of overseeing the accommodation and passes for Camp B (where civil society organizations and non-political forces stayed), and reported to Thorat and Joshi. Pushparaj worked on the civil society interactions, reporting to Digvijay Singh, Jairam Ramesh and Rahul Gandhi's team (K. Byju, Alankar Sawai, etc.). Carina Xavier worked with K. Byju and Pratishtha Singh in organizing the afternoon tea sessions. And, finally, Brijbhushan worked with Thorat, Abhijit Sapkal and Prithviraj Sathe in streamlining the Yatra's logistical operations.

While Camp A (where the Bharat yatris walking the entire Yatra stayed) was entirely managed by the Congress party's central team, Camp B and C fell into the state leadership's lap. Camp 3 was organized by local leaders and was to meet the needs of those people who would join the Yatra for one day. But Camp B was where all the buzz was! Pradesh yatris and Inter-State civil society yatris, who walked for at least two days in the fourteen days in Maharashtra, were housed in Camp B.

In theory, my job was limited to issuing passes on day one, and then broadly supervising that Camp B was functioning smoothly. But all my expectations went out of the window within an hour! The first problem we faced was that of space. It was anticipated that not more than 250 people would stay at Camp B. To our surprise, the first day started with 600 civil society yatris, and every day around 400 more were added! We had to scramble to arrange for food, accommodation, sanitation and medical